

Written Statement

Explain how the site for the proposed use is adequate in size and shape:

Certainly, a 3.87-acre parcel of land provides ample space for a mosque. Let me explain why:

1. **Land Area:** A 3.87-acre this is equivalent to at least **three football fields**. Such a sizable area allows for various facilities and activities.
2. **Mosque Space:**
 - **Main Building:** A mosque typically includes a **prayer hall**, ablution areas, and administrative rooms. With 3.87 acres, there's room for a spacious main building.
 - **Outdoor Areas:** The land can accommodate **courtyards, gardens, and open spaces** for congregants to gather, especially during festivals or community events.
 - **Parking:** Adequate parking space for worshippers' vehicles can be allocated.
3. **Community Engagement:**
 - Mosques serve as community centers. With this land size, you can host educational programs, daycare, social events, and outreach activities.
4. **Natural Beauty:**
 - The extra space allows for **landscaping**, planting trees, and creating a serene environment.
 - A **peaceful setting** enhances the spiritual experience for worshippers.

In summary, a 3.87-acre plot provides ample room for a mosque, supporting both its functional needs and community engagement.

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Explain how the proposed use will not have an adverse effect on the neighborhood or seriously conflict with the character of the area:

The proposed mosque will harmonize with the neighborhood and maintain the character of the area:

1. **Zoning compatibility:** The fact that the mosque is **allowed conditionally by the Bernalillo county** is a significant positive. It demonstrates that local authorities have already assessed its compatibility with the surrounding land use.
2. **Street Visibility:** To maintain the area's character, a **6-foot block wall** will encompass the lot perimeter. Combined with the primary structure's setback of roughly **280 feet** from this boundary, the facility will remain **virtually invisible** to pedestrians and motorists traveling along 2nd Street. Please refer to the attached exhibit (Visibility from 2nd street) for visual clarification.
3. **Neighboring Residential Benefits:** The five single-family residences situated to the north will realize several distinct advantages from the development of the Islamic Center:
 - **Buffer Zone:** The facility establishes a protective buffer between northern residential properties and the southern commercial corridor on Alameda. It serves as a **harmonious transition** between the established homes and business zones.
 - **Acoustic and Air Quality Buffer:** The building acts as a **physical shield**, significantly dampening ambient noise and reducing exposure to vehicle emissions from the main roads.
 - **Environmental Maintenance:** The facility serves as a **natural barrier** against dust and pests typically associated with retail zones. Additionally, the **rigorous upkeep** maintained by our nonprofit ensures a cleaner environment with minimal local pest activity.
 - **Visual Aesthetics:** Where visible beyond the perimeter wall or gate, the Center's distinctive architecture and professional landscaping will enhance the **visual appeal** of the neighborhood, preventing over-densification while preserving an atmosphere of open space.
 - **Real Estate Value Enhancement:** Across the nation, the development of stable community religious centers has consistently correlated with a **notable increase** in the desirability and market value of nearby properties.
4. **Community Engagement:**
 - The mosque can actively engage with the community. Regular **open houses, interfaith dialogues, and cultural events** can foster understanding and goodwill.

- **Community Outreach:** The mosque can collaborate with local schools, charities, and other organizations. This strengthens community bonds.

5. **Architectural Design:**

- The mosque's design should **complement** the existing architectural style of the area. Using similar materials and aesthetics ensures it blends harmoniously.
- **Landscaping:** Thoughtful landscaping can enhance the area. Consider native plants, green spaces, and water features.
- **Acoustic Containment:** To ensure neighborhood tranquility, the use of **external loudspeakers** or outdoor amplification systems is strictly prohibited.

6. **Traffic Management:**

- Work with local authorities to address any potential traffic impact concerns. Adequate parking and traffic flow plans are essential.
- **Peak Times:** Coordinate prayer times to minimize traffic during peak hours.

7. **Lighting and Signage:**

- Ensure exterior lighting is **subdued** and doesn't spill into neighboring properties.
- **Modest Signage:** Signage should be informative yet **unobtrusive**.

8. **Environmental Impact:**

- The mosque can adopt **sustainable practices** (such as rainwater harvesting, solar panels, and energy-efficient design).
- **Green Spaces:** Create green areas that benefit both worshippers and the community.

In summary, the proposed mosque, when thoughtfully planned and integrated, can coexist harmoniously with the neighborhood. It's essential to maintain open communication with residents, address concerns, and celebrate the positive contributions the mosque will bring to the community.

Explain the specific details concerning your proposal (hours, size, number of clients.. Etc.:

The specific details regarding the proposed mosque:

1. Hours of Operation:

- While building schedules fluctuate, the weekly **peak activity window** centers on **Friday mid-day**. This period corresponds to the essential Jumu'ah assembly. To alleviate potential congestion, the Center is prepared to **adjust service times** between 12:00 PM and 1:30 PM, following the guidance of expert engineers and/or County staff during a formal **design process**. During the highest weekly usage periods, we anticipate approximately **250 worshippers**. According to local zoning regulations, which mandate one stall for every four seats, this requires a minimum of **63 parking spaces**.
- On other days, the mosque will be open for regular prayers throughout the day. However, the visitor will be less than 25 persons.
- **Peak Event Capacity:** During biennial observances such as **Eid festivals**, the facility may reach its maximum occupancy. In these instances, we anticipate a surge of approximately **615 worshippers**. Based on jurisdictional standards, this peak volume necessitates **154 parking stalls**, a provision clearly delineated on the submitted site plan.

2. Building Size and Design:

- **Structural Modification:** The primary structure's footprint has been decreased by **4 feet** along the northern boundary. This adjustment expands the access aisle to a width of **26 feet**, ensuring full compliance with mandated **fire safety requirements** and emergency vehicle access.
- The **first floor** of the building will be approximately **43,288 square feet**.
- It will be a **1.5 story** structure, combining functionality with architectural aesthetics.
- Here's a breakdown of the building's layout: (see attached architecture plans)
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 - **Ground Floor:**
 - **Prayer Hall:** The heart of the mosque, where daily prayers take place. It accommodates worshippers during regular prayers.
 - **Ablution Areas:** Adjacent to the prayer hall, providing facilities for ritual purification (wudu).

- **Community Rooms:** Spaces for meetings, classes, and community events.
 - **Library:** A quiet area for reading religious texts and educational materials.
 - **Administrative Offices:** For mosque management and coordination.
 - **Upper Floor (Half-Story):**
 - **Women's Prayer Area:** A separate section for female worshippers.
 - **Imam's office:** Where the mosque's spiritual leader conducts counseling and guidance.
 - **Balcony:** Overlooking the prayer hall, providing additional capacity during peak times.
3. **Visitors and Congregants:**
- **Daily Visitors:** On regular days, the mosque expects around **25 to 35 visitors** throughout the day. These include worshippers, maintenance workers, and community members.
 - **Friday Noon (Jumu'ah):**
 - **Prayer Congregation:** The peak hours occur during the Friday Jumu'ah prayer.
 - **Approximately 250 worshippers** gather for the sermon (khutbah) and the congregational prayer.
 - The mosque will accommodate this larger congregation during the Friday service at noon.
 - During **biennial observances**, the center may accommodate its **maximum occupancy** of approximately **615 worshippers**.

In summary, the proposed mosque aims to serve the community by providing a serene space for worship, education, and fellowship. Its design and operations are carefully planned to align with both functional needs and the neighborhood's character.

Incidental Facilities: Teaching Rooms

This proposal has been revised to **exclude all educational components**. Consequently, all preschool, elementary, and middle school facilities have been **removed entirely** from the current plan. Should the Albuquerque Islamic Center intend to establish any instructional spaces in the future, a